

DS2002 Data Project 1

This project for both of us was a refresher in some aspects, but a challenge in others.

When thinking about how to read in the data, it felt natural to use pandas. It definitely made the process much easier for us as it helped us juggle all the different data types that we had. Another thing that was easier to do was the error handling. When implementing this in our code, we would refer back to previous labs and homeworks to try and replicate what we had done. The last thing we felt was simple to implement were the elements I would print out (inputs, dataframes, etc.). Because both of us have lots of familiarity with python, we were able to dedicate more time to making sure things looked as neat as possible.

Even though there were parts of the project that built off previous assignments, we still encountered plenty of challenges. The main challenge we had was figuring out how to save the data in SQL. We spent some time messing around with the website we used to do the SQL homework in the beginning of the year, but we could not find any way to make it work. This was until we came across the SQLite3 library, which allowed us to successfully convert the data into SQL. The second challenge we had, which ties into the first one, was figuring out a way to save the data locally. We were overcomplicating the process, looking for packages that would show us the current working directory, so that we could craft custom file paths to save our newly converted files. Later, we realized that simply using `df.to_(file_type)` would save the file in the current project folder, avoiding the need to find file paths. This utility will be very useful for almost all data projects we encounter. Being able to take certain data and transform it is a common theme we have seen in this class. I think learning to convert csv and json to SQL is the most useful, as manually reading in and inserting data with queries is much more tedious than the solution we provided.